MajorRaises

Major Raises

General Approach

- A simple raise to 2M covers two hands: 3-card support with 6–10 points, or exactly 6 points with 4-card support
- Use Bergen (3♣ or 3♦) to show 4-card support in the 7–12 point range
- Use a preemptive 3M to show 4-card support with 0–5 points (alertable)
- Use Splinter to show game-forcing 4 card support with a singleton or void. Usually the singleton or void is not an honor.
- Use Jacoby 2NT to show game-forcing **or better** 4 card support
- Use Drury with a passed hand to show 3+ card support and at least a minimum hand
- After a splinter bid, if opener has wasted honors in the short suit, opener usually will sign off in game

When to choose splinter or Jacoby 2NT

- A splinter usually is limited in point range to less-than-slam. It puts your partner in control of deciding how high.
- Because your honors are usually not in the splinter suit, partner could potentially explore slam if there’s a good fit in other suits and they don’t have many HCP in the splinter suit.
- Jacoby 2NT can be slam-worthy. It puts you in control of deciding how high.

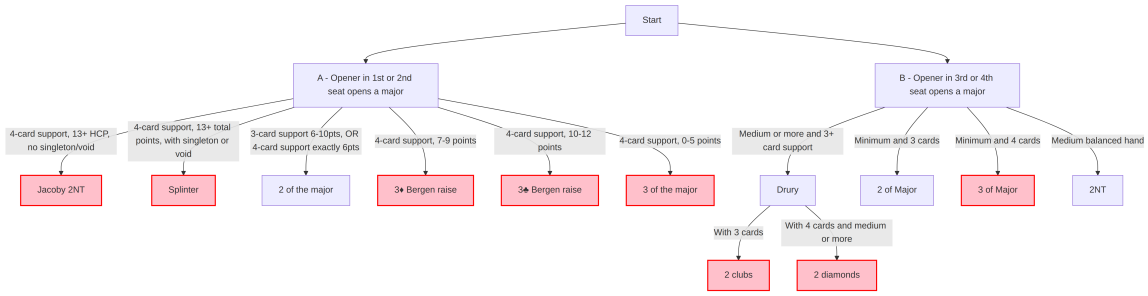

Diagram 1

Alertable